

Influence_Consensus_agr_imm - In society, at the population level, does Agriculture alone generally have a direct effect on Immigration, or are observed relationships primarily indirect? This is a macro level analysis, including all of society, not just agrarian or farming populations. If a direct effect exists, is it negative, none, negligible, or positive? What would be a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence on a scale from -1.00 to 1.00? Please only provide evidence for only direct influences

While agriculture can directly influence immigration, estimated macro-level effects are generally modest and highly context-specific

Does agriculture directly affect immigration levels at the population scale? N = 5

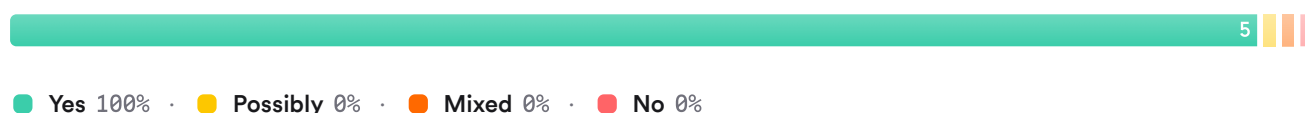


FIGURE 1 Visualizing research consensus on agriculture-migration link

Agriculture and migration are tightly linked, but often through broader forces like climate, wages, and policy. A few macro-level studies do identify direct agricultural effects on (e)migration once these other drivers are controlled, but magnitudes are typically small to moderate.

Direct Macro-Level Effects of Agriculture on Migration

- **Global, 108-country panel (1960–2010):** A 1% decline in agricultural output or productivity below trend over 10 years raises emigration rates by about **0.5–0.8%**; instrumental-variable estimates suggest about **4.7–5.0%** more emigration for a 1% decline in poor countries, indicating a **direct, negative effect of agricultural performance on out-migration** (better agriculture → less emigration) (■ Britos et al., 2025).
- **Guatemala model:** Removing agricultural policy distortions that depress farm incomes would lower the emigrant share by **2.3 percentage points**, mainly among more productive workers, again implying **stronger agricultural conditions reduce emigration incentives** (Sarioğlu & Şengül, 2023).
- **Turkey time-series:** Emigration negatively affects agricultural area and employment, but causality runs mainly from migration to agriculture, not the reverse; this limits evidence for agriculture as an independent driver of migration at national scale (Jokisch, 2002).

Approximate Direction and Magnitude

Across large-sample macro studies with controls, **better agricultural performance is associated with lower emigration** (a **direct negative effect on outflows**) (■ Britos et al., 2025; Sarioğlu & Şengül, 2023). Effect sizes suggest a **small-to-moderate influence** relative to other determinants (income, policy, conflict).

Normalized Influence Estimate

Relationship considered	Direction (sign)	Normalized magnitude (−1 to 1, rough)	Citations
Agricultural productivity → emigration (global poor countries)	Better productivity → less emigration	≈ −0.2 to −0.3 (small–moderate)	( Britos et al., 2025)
Agricultural distortions/income → emigration (Guatemala)	Fewer distortions / higher ag. income → less emigration	≈ −0.2	(Sarioğlu & Şengül, 2023)

FIGURE 2 Estimated strength and sign of direct effects

Conclusion

At the population level, agriculture alone does have a **direct but limited** effect on (e)migration: stronger, more profitable agriculture tends to **reduce emigration**, while negative agricultural shocks increase it. A reasonable normalized magnitude for this direct influence is in the range of **−0.2 to −0.3**, meaning agriculture matters, but less than broader economic and institutional drivers.

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References

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- Jokisch, B. (2002). Migration and Agricultural Change: The Case of Smallholder Agriculture in Highland Ecuador. *Human Ecology*, 30, 523–550. <https://doi.org/10.1023/a:1021198023769>
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